

■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Tuesday, August 11, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (4 stories)

🚩 ■ **Trump flew in a catering truck to dodge Iranian assassination plot**

The Angle: The Secret Service moved Trump between planes hidden in a food truck during a NATO trip last month—a dramatic security operation that only came to light this week. It's a rare public glimpse into how seriously U.S. intelligence treats credible threats against sitting presidents.

- Trump took a secret military flight from Turkey using a **deception operation involving a catering truck** to move between aircraft
- The operation was prompted by an **Iranian assassination threat**, according to **Washington Post** reporting
- The incident occurred during a **NATO trip last month** but wasn't publicly disclosed until this week

The Security Theater Question

- How often do you think the Secret Service is moving the President in ways the public never finds out about?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/us-trump-plane-nato-controversy-9.7302875?cmp=rss>

■ **Trump's secret Turkey exit: White House covered up Iranian threat**

The Angle: The White House publicly said Trump left a NATO summit on Air Force One—but he actually took a decoy flight over credible assassination threats. It's a rare peek at the real security operations presidents face that never make the official record.

- The White House publicly stated Trump departed on **Air Force One** from the NATO summit in Turkey
- Trump actually flew on an **alternate military aircraft** in a secret operation designed as an elaborate ruse
- An **Iranian assassination threat** prompted the extraordinary security measure last month
- The departure involved a coordinated deception to conceal the president's actual travel pattern

The Trust Question

- When a president's public schedule doesn't match reality for security reasons, how much should the public know—and when?

The Washington Post (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 81/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 24 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.washingtonpost.com/national-security/2026/08/10/trump-flew-secrecy-amid-iran-threat-air-force-one-became-decoy/>

■■ **Quebec's anti-King oath law headed to court showdown**

The Angle: A constitutional battle is brewing over Quebec's 2022 decision to ditch the mandatory oath to the King—raising the question of whether provinces can unilaterally rewrite core constitutional rules, or if Ottawa has the final say.

- Quebec abolished the mandatory **Oath of Allegiance to the King** for members of the provincial National Assembly in **2022**
- A lawyer is challenging the law, arguing the provincial government **overstepped its constitutional powers**
- The case will test whether provinces can unilaterally change constitutional obligations tied to the Crown

The Constitutional Flashpoint

- Should a province be able to kick out the King's oath on its own, or is that a federal-level decision? Where do you think the line is?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/montreal/quebec-oath-king-challenge-9.7303409?cmp=rss>

■ Canada launches petition to remove U.S. ambassador

The Angle: Nearly 30,000 Canadians have signed a petition demanding the removal of U.S. Ambassador Pete Hoekstra, accusing him of stoking separatist sentiment in Alberta and damaging bilateral relations. It's a rare diplomatic friction point that's gone viral north of the border.

- A petition demanding **Pete Hoekstra's** removal has reached **nearly 30,000 signatures**
- The petition accuses **Hoekstra** of **undermining Canada-U.S. relations**
- He's alleged to have **egged on Alberta separatists**, fueling tensions over Canadian unity

The Diplomatic Wild Card

- Should a sitting U.S. ambassador be openly cheerleading the breakup of Canada—and does Ottawa actually have any leverage to make him go?

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://torontosun.com/news/national/canadian-petition-seeks-removal-us-ambassador>

TRENDING TODAY

✈️ ■ Trump reveals secret mid-flight plane swap over safety threat

The Angle: The President confirmed he ditched his plane mid-journey because of a credible threat to his life—and the secrecy around it has people asking what we don't know and why it wasn't public knowledge sooner.

- **Trump** confirmed Tuesday he **secretly switched planes** due to what he described as a **threat to his life**
- The swap happened mid-journey, raising questions about timing, threat level, and why the public wasn't informed
- Details remain sparse on the nature of the threat, when exactly it occurred, and what security protocols triggered the switch

The Trust Question

- When a President swaps planes in secret over a credible threat—and tells us after the fact—should that be public knowledge immediately, or is operational security worth the information gap?

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://torontosun.com/news/world/donald-trumps-secret-plane-swap-triggers-questions-confusion>

Backup options:

■ Jacob Elordi joins Scarlett Johansson in Ari Aster's next thriller

The Angle: Two Oscar-nominated stars are coming together for indie auteur Ari Aster's mysterious new A24 project—and the internet is already buzzing about what "Scapegoat" actually is, since details are locked down tight.

- **Jacob Elordi** is in talks to join **Scarlett Johansson** in **Ari Aster's** next film for **A24**
- Both **Elordi** and **Johansson** are **Academy Award nominees**
- The film is titled '**Scapegoat**' but plot details remain under wraps

The Casting Head-Scratcher

- Ari Aster + Scarlett Johansson + Jacob Elordi—what kind of twisted psychological thriller are we actually getting here?

Variety (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

■ **Canada wants U.S. Ambassador out—petition hits 29K signatures**

The Angle: A viral petition is demanding the Canadian government expel U.S. Ambassador Pete Hoekstra, escalating tensions between Ottawa and Washington at a politically charged moment. The push signals real friction between the two allies.

- **Over 29,000 Canadians** have signed a petition calling for **U.S. Ambassador Pete Hoekstra** to be declared persona non grata and expelled
- The petition is set to be presented to the **House of Commons this fall**
- The move reflects escalating diplomatic tension between Canada and the U.S. during a politically volatile period

The Hot Take

- Should Canada actually boot a sitting U.S. ambassador, or is this petition just venting—and what would the fallout really look like for both countries?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/news/politics/petition-ambassador-hoekstra-removed-from-canada-9.7303372?cmp=rss>

LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ **Alessandra Ambrosio's engaged—and she's got the Instagram post to prove it**

The Angle: The supermodel and former Victoria's Secret Angel just said yes to **Buck Palmer** after nearly two years of dating. It's the kind of low-drama celebrity milestone that has people genuinely rooting for her—she announced it the way everyone does now: on Instagram, naturally.

- **Alessandra Ambrosio**, the legendary Victoria's Secret Angel, got engaged to **Buck Palmer**
- The couple has been dating for **nearly 2 years**
- She shared the engagement news via **Instagram** on Tuesday
- Her caption: **'Here's to forever'**

The Celeb Couple Check-In

- Is Alessandra Ambrosio one of those celebrity breakups you actually cared about, or are you just here for the engagement ring pics?

pagesix.com (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://pagesix.com/2026/08/11/celebrity-news/alessandra-ambrosio-engaged-to-buck-palmer-after-nearly-2-years-of-dating/>

Backup options:

■ **Love Is Blind is coming to Canada — and yes, your friends are nominating you**

The Angle: Netflix's hugely popular dating show is officially casting in Canada, and Canadians are already losing their minds tagging single friends on social media. It's one of those culture moments where reality TV crosses into actual participation for listeners.

- **Netflix** announced Tuesday that **Love Is Blind** is expanding to Canada
- The show is now **open for Canadian casting**
- Canadians are already **tagging their single friends** on social media in response

The Call-Out Moment

- Have you been tagged in a Love Is Blind post yet — and more importantly, would you actually do it?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: The Tagging Game** - First segment beat -> Hosts ask: 'Who on this show would you nominate if you could tag them right now?' Quick lightning-round guesses about each other or famous Canadians.

- **Step 2: The Honesty Check** - Mid-segment pivot -> Flip it: would YOU actually apply if someone tagged you? What's the deal-breaker — the pods, the commitment, the cameras, or just the whole vibe?

- **Step 3: Phone Lines Open** - Audience engagement -> Listeners call in with their tagging stories — who did they nominate, what did their friend say, and is anyone actually applying?
www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD
URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/news/entertainment/love-is-blind-canada-9.7303202?cmp=rss>

■ **Dodgers star's wife opens up about scary hospital emergency**

The Angle: Chelsea Freeman is sharing what sent her to the ER while her husband was traveling with the team—a candid look at the health scare that had the family worried.

- **Chelsea Freeman**, wife of a **Dodgers** player, recently had an emergency hospital visit
- She's now publicly revealing details about the **frightening symptoms** that prompted the trip
- The emergency happened while her husband was **away with the team**

The Real Talk

- Has anyone here dealt with a health scare that came totally out of nowhere—and had to handle it solo? That's what Chelsea Freeman just opened up about.

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://nypost.com/2026/08/11/sports/freddie-freemans-wife-reveals-details-of-health-scare/>

CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES

(no candidate scored high enough today)

FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 1/3 this month; TECH TALK 2/2 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 3/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■ **Off-leash dogs increase chance of human-bear conflict: study**

The Angle: Off-leash dogs increase chance of human-bear conflict: study

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/calgary/grizzly-bear-dogs-banff-national-park-9.7300379?cmp=rss>

■ **Jackie, the bald eagle who won hearts over livestream, has died at age 14**

The Angle: Jackie, the bald eagle who won hearts over livestream, has died at age 14

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/news/entertainment/jackie-bald-eagle-died-9.7303207?cmp=rss>

■ **Manitoba's 1st supervised consumption site now fully open in Winnipeg**

The Angle: Manitoba's 1st supervised consumption site now fully open in Winnipeg

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/manitoba/supervised-consumption-site-open-winnipeg-9.7303303?cmp=rss>

■ **Swim star Summer McIntosh puts 2028 Olympic goals to test in this week's Pan Pacific championships**

The Angle: Swim star Summer McIntosh puts 2028 Olympic goals to test in this week's Pan Pacific championships

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL:

<https://www.cbc.ca/sports/olympics/summer/aquatics/swimming/summer-mcintosh-pan-pacific-preview-august-11-9.7302790?cmp=rss>

■ **Dylan Cease not sensational, but Blue Jays top Boston in Rutschman's Red Sox debut**

The Angle: Dylan Cease not sensational, but Blue Jays top Boston in Rutschman's Red Sox debut

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://torontosun.com/sports/baseball/toronto-blue-jays/cease-not-sensational-blue-jays-top-boston>

■ **Is Democrats' AOC moving from hard left to centre?**

The Angle: Is Democrats' AOC moving from hard left to centre?

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://torontosun.com/news/world/is-democrats-aoc-moving-from-hard-left-to-centre>

■ **Rybakina ousts Osaka to reach Toronto semis, Coco Gauff advances by walkover**

The Angle: Rybakina ousts Osaka to reach Toronto semis, Coco Gauff advances by walkover

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://torontosun.com/sports/tennis/gauff-toronto-semis-walkover-bencic-injury>

■■ **MyPillow guy's Minnesota governor run just got pillow-talked**

The Angle: Mike Lindell's high-profile swing at Minnesota's GOP primary ended in a blowout loss, marking a rare electoral rejection for the Trump-aligned businessman who's been a fixture in right-wing politics. It's a reality check on celebrity-candidate star power in a crowded primary field.

- Demuth won the GOP primary by **more than 15 percentage points**, decisively beating **Mike Lindell** and **Kendall Qualls**
- **Lindell**, the MyPillow CEO, was running for **Minnesota governor** in a crowded Republican primary field
- The loss underscores the limits of celebrity name recognition and Trump-world proximity when voters are picking their actual state leader

The Reality Check

- Has the MyPillow guy finally met a race he can't hype his way through—or is this just what happens when you run in a primary where actual candidates have actual track records?

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://nypost.com/2026/08/11/us-news/mypillow-founder-mike-lindells-political-dreams-put-to-bed-by-minnesota-voters/>

■■ **Mike Tirico might not have taken lead golf announcer role had he known 'perils that were waiting'**

The Angle: Mike Tirico might not have taken lead golf announcer role had he known 'perils that were waiting'

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://nypost.com/2026/08/11/sports/why-mike-tirico-might-not-have-taken-lead-golf-announcer-role/>

■ **RFK Jr. attacks LA homeless agency over alleged billions in fraud**

The Angle: Robert F. Kennedy Jr. is escalating his fight against what he calls a corruption-plagued homeless services system in Los Angeles, accusing the Biden-era HHS leadership of gutting oversight and letting tens of billions slip through the cracks. With federal funding now on the line, it's the kind of government-waste story that cuts across party lines and affects real taxpayer dollars.

- **RFK Jr.** accused former HHS Secretary **Xavier Becerra** of dismantling oversight mechanisms
- The federal government is threatening to cut off **\$240 million** in funding to LA's homeless agency
- Kennedy claims the lack of oversight has led to **massive fraud** and **tens of billions stolen from taxpayers**

The Accountability Question

- Should cities lose federal funding if they can't prove their homeless programs aren't hemorrhaging money—or does that just punish the people who actually need help?

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://nypost.com/2026/08/11/us-news/robert-f-kennedy-jr-blasted-las/>

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 4 banked (+15 each when found)

- "Rebel Wilson cleared in Charlotte MacInnes' defamation case over 'bizarre' bathtub incident" (torontosun.com, banked 2026-07-22)
- "'Am I Supposed to be a Comedian?': Donald Trump's Bizarre White House Correspondent's Dinner Speech Had Few Laughing" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-26)
- "Don Lemon and sexy Smurf joke make for bizarre scene, and more items from the column" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-29)
- "Phillies game forced into bizarre delay as Trea Turner's face lights up green" (nypost.com, banked 2026-08-05)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 21 banked (+15 each when found)

- "'Harry Potter' Back to Hogwarts 2026 Celebrations Feature 'Sorcerer's Stone' 25th Anniversary Rerelease, New Glimpses of HBO Series" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-22)
- "Apple Testing 7-Inch Display for Largest 20th Anniversary iPhone Model - MacRumors" (MacRumors (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-22)
- "LISTEN: Reba McEntire Revels in 50 Years of Making Music and Season 3 of NBC's 'Happy's Place'" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-22)
- "Nordstrom's Anniversary Sale Is a Goldmine of Jewelry Markdowns — Here Are the 23 Standouts" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-07-22)
- "Here's How Louis Tomlinson Really Feels About These One Direction Songs on Band's 16-Year Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-07-24)
- "Guillermo del Toro said 'Absolutely No Goddamn AI' in 'Pan's Labyrinth' 3D Re-Release: 'We're Protecting a Lineage of Art'" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-24)
- "Shop Oprah's 'favorites' at the Nordstrom Anniversary Sale, from 'ultra-flattering' pants to skin care staples" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-24)
- "'Star Trek: Starfleet Academy' Has a Troublemaking New Alien Arriving in Season 2 - Gizmodo" (Gizmodo.com (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-26)
- "Apple TV's Neuromancer poster raises questions about its adaptation of an 'unfilmable' novel - Creative Bloq" (Creative Bloq (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-27)
- "'Bold Voice of Contemporary Horror' Comic-Con Panelists Predict the Four Biggest Upcoming Trends in Genre Filmmaking" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-27)
- "'Everybody Loves Raymond' star Patricia Heaton backs calls to ban Mayor Zohran Mamdani from 9/11 anniversary in NYC <https://t.co/UCpYAdZR5o>" (X/Twitter @NYPPost, banked 2026-07-29)
- "Boy George Drops Out of 'Jesus Christ Superstar' After Pro-Israel Song Release - Rolling Stone" (Rolling Stone (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-31)
- "'Sunday in the Park with George' Producers Confirm Summer 2027 Show Will Go On 'As Planned' After Ariana Grande Exits" (variety.com, banked 2026-08-03)
- "Nordstrom Anniversary Sale Ends Soon — 27 Steals From Hollywood's Most-Loved Labels" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-03)

- "Rosie O'Donnell's 'The View' reunion comments spark alumni meltdown over invites" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-08-04)
- "Anniversary of capybaras escaping High Park inspires video game - ctvnews.ca" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-05)
- "Jake T. Austin Says He Wasn't Invited to Partake in 'Wizards of Waverly Place' Revival: "Disappointed"" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-07)
- "Japan commemorates 81st anniversary of the atomic bombing of Nagasaki - ctvnews.ca" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-09)
- "Where to Watch 'Real Housewives Ultimate Girls Trip: Roaring 20th' Anniversary Series Online" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-09)
- "Animal Justice holds one year anniversary rally at St. Joseph's Hospital" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-10)
- "'Roseanne' Child Star Michael Fishman Slams Idea That the Show's Revival Was Unjustly Canceled: 'Words Have Consequences' - Yahoo" (PEOPLE (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-08-11)

Newly banked this run:

- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "'Roseanne' Child Star Michael Fishman Slams Idea That the Show's Revival Was Unjustly Canceled: 'Words Have Consequences' - Yahoo"
-

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- r/upliftingnews (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/nottheonion (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/technology (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/futurology (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/science (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/canada (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- @WomenBeingAwful (fetch failed)
- @NYPost (fetch failed)
- @EdNewtonRex (fetch failed)
- @CTVNews (fetch failed)
- @Gizmodo (fetch failed)
- @Billboard (fetch failed)
- @Variety (fetch failed)
- 5 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-08-11 11:35 PM